and they can be reversed. This was why it was important to embody the reforms in new institutional mechanisms, as well as build ownership of reforms within the RBI and amongst external stakeholders.

And that brings me to teamwork. This was not my first job in management. But I became head of an organization of 17,000 people, with assets of more than $400 billion. How does one manage such a large organization? Obviously with help. I have always found that the single most important task in management is to pick good deputies, and I managed to get very good ones. My role was to set the overall agenda (of course, in consultation with them), get the concurrence of the government, draw out the vast experience of my colleagues to fill out the details and rule out inadvisable steps, push and prod the organization where necessary so that we stuck to timelines, and then roll out the measures after engaging with stakeholders, including the public.

We did not undertake reforms by stealth. While the full import of some of the actions we took may not have been obvious early on, making it harder for opposition to crystallize, the roadmap for much of what we did was set by various RBI-appointed committees, advertised in public speeches, and then implemented after discussion with stakeholders. We were always willing to listen to alternative proposals from them, but any suggestion had to pass my test of economic or financial commonsense, and my colleagues' test of meeting sensible central and commercial banking practice, before it was accepted. By and large, these dual filters helped us screen out unhelpful suggestions.

Our reforms were guided by the need to increase the role of markets and improve competition, to ensure we had the right regulations and the regulations were enforced in a predictable and